

Nicholas (Nic) Jones

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Washington, D.C. · **Top Secret Clearance**

SUMMARY

Information Security Manager and hands-on security engineer with 7+ years across enterprise security, offensive security, and cloud. Lead security strategy and analysts at T-Rex and network security for the U.S. Department of Education. Published vulnerability researcher, former Synack Red Team member, and repeat SANS NetWars champion. CISSP, OSCP, GPEN, GCIH, GCIA, GSEC, GDSA, GSTRT, and AWS Solutions Architect Professional.

EXPERIENCE

T-Rex Solutions, LLC (*Bethesda, MD - Remote*) June 2019 – Present

- **Information Security Manager (Jan. 2024 – Present)**
 - Develop and execute T-Rex information security strategy and manage information security analysts
 - Plan and engineer security architecture for the T-Rex enterprise
- **Lead Information Security Analyst (May 2020 – Jul. 2022)**
 - Conducted periodic penetration tests, managed network infrastructure, and developed incident response exercises
 - Led MITRE ATT&CK adoption and ISO 27001 preparation, and managed the information security intern
 - Supported a research project using AWS CDK to orchestrate multi-account AWS architectures
 - Cross-trained team members and supported cloud technology lab projects (TLPs)
- **Cybersecurity Analyst (Aug. 2019 – May 2020)**
 - Reported to the CISO/CIO and led malicious email analysis and vulnerability & patch management
 - Performed cloud security architecture, security awareness training, and network monitoring
- **Cybersecurity Intern (Jun. 2019 – Aug. 2019)**
 - Supported the security team in implementing Splunk and developing procedures, policies, compliance, and training

U.S. Department of Education (*Washington, D.C. - Remote, via T-Rex*) September 2024 – Present

- **Network Security Manager (Apr. 2025 – Present)**
 - Manage network security for the U.S. Department of Education
- **Cloud Engineer (Sep. 2024 – Apr. 2025)**
 - Supported cloud engineering initiatives for the U.S. Department of Education

Palantir Technologies (*Washington, D.C. - Remote, via T-Rex*) June 2022 – December 2023

- **Data Engineer (Jun. 2022 – Dec. 2023)**
 - Engineered Palantir Foundry data pipelines in Python, PySpark, and TypeScript to ingest, clean, and normalize critical government data
 - Re-architected SIEM platform for security event logging and detection

Synack Red Team (*Freelance*) May 2022 – August 2024

- **Security Researcher (May 2022 – Aug. 2024)**
 - Selected for the Synack Red Team (SRT), a vetted bug bounty and penetration testing program, through technical assessments and interviews
 - Tested web, host, and mobile targets and reported security vulnerabilities for Synack's clients

Early Career

Applications Tester & Developer – Mobius Intelligent Systems (<i>Laurel, MD - Remote</i>)	May 2019 – Sep. 2019
SOC Analyst/Engineer – Capitol Technology University Cyber Lab (<i>Laurel, MD</i>)	Mar. 2019 – Sep. 2019
Data Technician – ADNET Systems, Inc. (<i>NASA GSFC, Greenbelt, MD</i>)	Dec. 2018 – May 2019
IT Intern – CSRA, Inc. (<i>Falls Church, VA</i>)	Dec. 2017 – Jan. 2018

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Information Security Engineering – SANS Technology Institute October 2024 – May 2027 (Expected)

- 4.0 GPA, National Cyber League (NCL) Scholarship Winner (Fall 2024 & Spring 2025)

Master of Science in Cybersecurity – Wilmington University August 2021 – August 2023

- Graduated, 4.0 GPA, Epsilon Pi Tau Honor Society

Bachelor of Science in Cyber & Information Security – Capitol Technology University August 2016 – May 2020

- Graduated, 3.8 GPA, Dean's List (x4), Magna Cum Laude, Upsilon Pi Epsilon Honor Society

CERTIFICATIONS

Information Security & Technology Certifications

GIAC Penetration Tester (GPEN)	2026 – 2030
GIAC Certified Intrusion Analyst (GCIA)	2026 – 2030
SANS Security Awareness Professional (SSAP)	2025 – 2029
GIAC Defensible Security Architecture (GDSA)	2025 – 2029
GIAC Strategic Planning, Policy, and Leadership (GSTRT)	2025 – 2029
GIAC Certified Incident Handler (GCIH)	2025 – 2029
GIAC Security Essentials (GSEC)	2024 – 2028
ISC2 CISSP	2024 – 2027
OSCP	2021 – Lifetime
CEH	2020 – 2026
ITIL v4 Foundation	2019 – Lifetime
CompTIA CySA+, Security+, Network+, A+, ITF+	2017 – 2028

Cloud & Development Certifications

GitHub Actions	2024 – 2027
GitHub Foundations	2024 – 2027
ISACA CMMI Associate	2024 – 2027
AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional	2023 – 2029
AWS Certified Security Specialty	2022 – 2025
Azure Security Engineer Associate (AZ-500)	2020 – 2027

VULNERABILITY RESEARCH & PROJECTS

Published CVEs

CVE-2026-62183 – Apache Syncope: User self-service privilege escalation	Jul. 2026
CVE-2024-43404 – Remote Code Execution Vulnerability in MEGABOT	Aug. 2024

Projects

UNICORD – Security research organization developing proof-of-concept exploits for known CVEs	May 2022 – Present
• CVE-2025-29927: Next.js Middleware Authorization Bypass · CVE-2022-25765: pdfkit Command Injection · CVE-2021-22204: ExifTool Arbitrary Code Execution · CVE-2020-5844: Pandora FMS Remote Code Execution · CVE-2021-3560: Polkit Local Privilege Escalation	
HAMRadioWallet.com – App that adds FCC amateur radio licenses to Apple Wallet and Google Wallet	Jul. 2024 – Sep. 2024
• Built with Next.js and TypeScript · Integrated with Apple Wallet and Google Wallet APIs · Deployed using SST (Serverless Stack)	
GitHub Discord Bot – Serverless bot that subscribes Discord channels to GitHub repository events	Jan. 2024 – Jun. 2024
• Built with AWS Lambda and AWS SQS · Integrated GitHub Webhooks and Discord APIs · Serverless architecture for scalability	

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Information Security Engineering:** Cloud-native technologies, SIEMs, Splunk, Sentinel, Penetration Testing, Incident Response, Vulnerability Research
- **Cloud Architecture & Engineering:** AWS, Azure, Serverless Technologies, AWS CDK, Multi-account Architectures
- **Software Development:** Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, PySpark, PHP, MySQL
- **DevSecOps:** CI/CD, GitHub Workflows, Infrastructure as Code

AWARDS & WINS

SANS Core NetWars Tournament @ SANSFIRE – 1st Place - Solo	2025 & 2026
SANS Defense NetWars Tournament @ SANSFIRE – 1st Place - Team Game	2026
SANS DFIR NetWars Tournament @ SANS Security West – 1st Place - Team Game	2026
SANS Core NetWars Tournament @ SANS Security West – 1st Place - Team Game	2026
National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2026 Team Game – 1st Place - Experienced Students Bracket	2026
SANS NetWars Tournament of Champions @ Cyber Defense Initiative – 5th Place - Solo	2025
National Cyber League (NCL) Fall 2025 Team Game – 3rd Place - Experienced Students Bracket	2025
National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2025 Team Game – 4th Place - Experienced Students Bracket	2025
Parsons Cyber CTF – 1st Place (2019), 2nd Place (2024), 3rd Place (2019)	2019 & 2024
CT Cubed CTF @ DEFCON – 1st Place	2023
BSides Charm Exabeam CTF – 1st Place	2023
Maryland Cyber Challenge – 3rd Place	2019
Boy Scouts of America Eagle Scout Award – 3 additional palms	2014